

Tafseer Surah Fil - Surah Nas Exam 1 Study Guide

Connection between Surah Fil and Surah Quraysh

- "It is as if these surahs are a response to the dua of Ibrahim" - "Make this place safe for my family and bless them with good, clean sustenance."
- Surah Fil speaks about the safety aspect of the dua and Surah Quraysh speaks about the economy aspect of the dua

Surah Fil

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkah

Surah Number: 105

Order of Revelation: 19

Number of Ayahs: 5

Theme and Subject Matter: Protection of the Kabah, Allah's Might

Background of Surah- Story of Abraha:

- Abraha was a foreigner from Habasha
- Najashi sent the army of Abraha to push Persians out of Yemen; Yemen had more monotheism than Makkah at the time
- Abraha got jealous of the Makkans enjoying the ka'bah (mainly economic advantage) because they weren't even true believers
- He built a ka'ba in Yemen and Makkans retaliated proudly by burning part of it
- Abraha stopped in Ta'if on the way to Makkah and got their support
- Why was it called "Army of the Elephants" despite there only being 9-13 elephants?
 1. To invoke fear in Makkans; they had never seen one before
 2. The people in that army were so low that Allah didn't even want to refer to them; elephants had more intellect than the people
 3. The elephants were more significant because they were the ones that stopped walking towards the ka'bah

[1] ألم ترى - "Did you not see" - "Have you not considered"

- Two meanings: It gives the meaning of something you see physically (literally) with your eyes, or you visualize with your mind (figuratively)
رأي - opinion → you have an opinion because you know it happened even if you didn't see it with your own two eyes; Year of the Elephant was something everyone knew of
- This ayah is speaking to the Prophet SAW and the leaders of the Quraysh who physically never saw what happened to army of Abraha

- Allah uses the word **فعل** which means “to deal” instead of **هلك** which is “to destroy,” to show how insignificant this is for Allah. He is essentially saying, “I sent birds after them when I could have sent angels or lions”

[2] “Did He not place their plan into misguidance?”

تضليل - someone who has the correct intention but took the wrong path

[3] “And He sent against them birds in flocks.”

طيرا - all types of birds

أبائيل - type of formation in flanks of rows

[4] **سجیل** - pebbles

- Refers to the type of pebbles that form on the ground in the rain and then get baked in extreme heat of sun; these pebbles burnt the skin of the army and infected it

[5] “And He made them like eaten straw”

- Everyone except the army survived (we know this because Bilal’s parents from Habasha came as slaves with the army of Abraha and this is how Bilal RA came to Makkah)

فجعل - the letter **ف** being added shows IMMEDIATE

- Immediately after pebbles hit the army, they were like straw; already chewed up food

Final key points:

- Abraha’s demise was his arrogance; we don’t know if he was a true monotheist
- Nationalism can never be stronger than tawheed like it was for Abraha for Yemen

Surah Quraysh

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 106

Order of Revelation: 29

Number of Ayahs: 4

Theme and Subject Matter: 1. Safety against fear, 2. To remove harm and give benefit, 3. Recognizing Allah’s favors

Previous Surah: Abu Zayd said “every ayah of Surat Al-Fil is connected to the first ayah of the surah”

قرش = largest fish in the ocean, to trade a lot

- Both definitions fit the tribe of Quraysh

[1] **إيلاف** comes from **ألف** which means love and compassion, almost a sense of reverence

- Due to the reverence and love everyone had for Quraysh, they had more customs/protection
 - This أَلْف came from Allah; Quraysh had an easier time traveling and being respected
- Allah is saying, "It is not because of you that you are the host of the ka'ba- it is because of Me."
 - removing the arrogance of Quraysh

[2] رحلة = to travel

1. With baggage
2. Harder trip; not vacation; more lengthy trip
 - a. Trip of knowledge or trade

[3] "Let them worship the Lord of this House."

- You have all the special treatment but this House belongs to Allah

[4] "(He is the Same One) Who has fed them, and made them (feel) safe from fear."

- First step is for Quraysh to recognize their blessings and next they need to reflect on that

أَطْعَم = presenting food in a good manner

- The way they throw packages from the sky in Gaza is opposite of أَطْعَم

Surah Ma'un

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 107

Order of Revelation: 17

Number of Ayahs: 7

Theme and Subject Matter: People who question the Judgement, orphans and poor people, people who are neglectful of their prayers

Connection between Surah Quraysh and Surah Ma'un

- The reason you've been able to succeed in your life or not and what exactly is holding you back
- If it weren't for this specific quality, you would be more successful: denial, making excuses for yourself

[1] "Have you seen the people who deny the Day of Recompensation?"

أَرَأَيْتَ relates to أَلَمْ تَرَى in Surah Fil

دين (Deena) comes from دين (Dayna) = "To turn around"

- DOJ is when you will be recompensed for all the good/bad
- Believing in Allah was not difficult for Quraysh; it was more difficult for them to humble themselves and believe that they would be judged by someone higher

- When things are going our way in life, we tend to act like Quraysh and rely on outcomes even though Allah is giving us things to test us and hiding our sins out of His mercy

كذب (Kadhaba) means to lie, كذب (Kadhiba) means to believe

- The Quraysh had said the lie of akhirah not existing so much that they began believing it
يَكْذِبُ بَدِينٍ means to deny something because of believing your own lie; a way to liberate yourself from the consequence

What are they struggling to change? → Social inequality

[2] "For that is the one who drives away the orphan."

- Quraysh loved money and struggled to accept that society was changing (Bilal RA praying alongside them)
- They continuously took advantage of orphans and stole their wealth

دع means to push someone who has no power to push back (orphans)

[3] "And does not encourage the feeding of the poor."

حَضَّ means to encourage

- Referring to someone who won't even allow/encourage it

فَقِيرٍ means "you cannot tell they are poor"

مَسْكِينٍ means "you can tell they are poor"

- This ayah is talking about people who are so poor you don't have an excuse to lie and say you didn't know they needed it
- Ayahs 2 and 3 speak about social issues

Difference of opinion if this surah is Makki or Madani

- Salah didn't take place in Makkah; how could this be a Makki surah?
- But this surah speaks about social issues that only existed in Makkah, not Madinah really
- Consensus is that different verses revealed in different places

[4] "Woe be to those who pray."

وَيْلٌ means to regret

- In this ayah, وَيْلٌ is the deepest valley in Jahannum
- Allah is referring to the munaafiqeen in this ayah; they pray but heedlessly and to show on

[5] "They are the ones who pray by mistake"

سَهَةً means mistake (sajdah sahn)

- Ibn Abbas says a heedless prayer is 1. When a person waits until the last few minutes to pray, going up and down like a bird and 2. In prayer, they are heedless

[6] "Those who make a show of their deeds."

[7] "And withhold simple assistance"

منع means to assist; holding back the easiest task, something that will keep them alive (like food for Palestinians)

غفلة means heedless in all matters; a disease of the heart; chronic

سهو means heedless only in Islamic matters; a choice

Surah Kawthar

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkan some say Madinan

Surah Number: 108

Order of Revelation: 15

Number of Ayahs: 3

Theme and Subject Matter: What Allah gave to the Prophet in this life and the next, command for thankfulness, condemnation for the enemies of Allah's Messenger

Connection between Surah Kawthar and surahs before it

- Ones before about people who deny the DOJ, Kawthar is about those who affirm it

Background of Surah:

- In the early days of Makkah, the Prophet was heavily persecuted; Allah send wahiyy to comfort him
- Qaasim passed away between 6-16 months; Abu Lahab went to the streets and made fun of him, saying "Prophet's message won't spread, his lineage died today."
- This surah is how scholars deduced you must read 3 short ayat or one ayah in length to this surah for salah to count

[1] "Indeed we have granted you (Oh Muhammad), al -Kawthar."

اعطيناك - same word used for giving a son and giving a surah

[2] "So pray to your Lord and sacrifice (to Him alone)."

فصل = the ف makes it immediate

- The greatest way to get healed is to connect to the One who is the Healer; spirituality won't take away the jolt of the hardship- it helps you deal with that hardship

ونحر = to sacrifice a goat like you would at the birth of a child

- Solutions won't be found outside of salah
- Be charitable; don't hold back out of fear of losing what you have

[3] "Indeed, your enemy is the one cut off"

- Ayah 1, Allah uses أعطى for a gift which means it is an exclusive big gift- prophethood
- In this ayah, أتى is used for a smaller, common gift (like wealth)
- After Kawthar was gifted, the Prophet responded, "This gift cannot be replicated, but it is a gift only for me. What about a gift for my ummah?"
 - Allah said, "Kawthar is yours but your entire ummah can drink from it"
 - Then He gifted Surah Qadr, giving Laylatul Qadr to everyone

كوثر comes from كثر (Kathura) which means abundant

- Its cups are more than the number of stars
- These cups are a gift to the Prophet and he gifts them to us
- First tafseer of this ayah is that Allah is telling the Prophet, "I took your child but I am gifting you a lot."
 - Imaam Muhaasabi says, "You don't have the right to share bad news with people if you don't love them."
- It is based on our love of the Prophet and applying sunnah to our lives
- Allah talks about challenges He will test us with in the Quran
 1. Touch of fear
 2. Hunger
 3. Wealth
 4. health/life
 5. Fruits الثمرات - referring to the loss of a child; separate because it is the most difficult test

Stages of Akhira

1. Everyone raised up
2. Gathering
3. Reckoning
4. Bridge
5. Kawthar
 - a. Question arises "Can anyone be sent back from Kawthar?" → Yes, hadith

شأنه - enemy (Abu Lahab)

- Abu Lahab won't have a legacy after dying because the Prophet won't be with him
- His sons were murdered; entire lineage destroyed

Final key points:

- Loss is often the first step to turning away from Allah and to Allah
- Three days is such a wise time frame of grieving; imagine if there was no time limit- we would never get up or recover
 - What's going to fill that gap of the loss is the One who put you there
- What's even worse than being stingy with your wealth is being stingy in your time and presence. It is in your head that you are too busy to help others.
- Don't let your application of the sunnah turn someone away from that sunnah
 - People don't know sunnah because of reading a book; they know it bc of you

Surah Kafirun

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkah

Surah Number: 109

Order of Revelation: 18

Number of Ayahs: 6

Theme and Subject Matter: The Muslims' total disgust towards the worship of the disbelievers, Islam and Kufr have nothing in common

Connection between Surah Kafirun and surahs around it

- The Prophet would pray sunnah for Fajr with Kafirun and Ikhlas
 - Tawheed is the common theme between the two
 - Kafirun is the framing while Ikhlas is closure
- Nasr and Lahab in between are the details; Nasr talks about difficulty and outcome for those who choose to believe; Lahab is for those who do not believe
- Top patty: Kafirun → What choice will you make?
- Middle patties: Nasr and Lahab → Two choice options
- Bottom patty: Ikhlas → Tawheed protects you from internal tests like hasad, etc
 - To protect yourself, recite Falaq and Nas

Background of Surah:

- This surah is the only one where Allah calls upon the disbelievers directly
 - This is a surah spoken to a certain group of people and anyone who is like them; arrogant and ignorant
- 5-6 leaders in Makkah either went directly to Prophet to offer deal "one year our lords, one year Allah" OR they had Abu Talib speak on their behalf
- They didn't understand that he (SAW) was standing for something that gave him no dunya benefit and harmed him on top of them
- "If you want power, we'll give it to you. Worship who you want to worship but some giving da'wah." → presence of Islam is power, threatening to Quraysh

[1] "Say "Oh disbelievers"

قل added for extra/highest level of command to Prophet

- Say it right away and keep saying it

[2] "I do not worship what you worship"

- Do not overstate or overemphasize your piety
- The goal is to tell people "I am excellent **because** I am Muslim."

[3] "Nor are you worshippers of what I worship"

- The Prophet never did shirk even before Islam

[4] Repeating to emphasize

[5] "You will never be a worshipper of what I worship."

[6] "For you is your religion and for me is my religion"

دين means consequence/to pray back

- Before it meant religion, it meant consequences- "For you will be your consequences, for me will be my outcome"

Surah Nasr

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Madinan

Surah Number: 110

Order of Revelation: 114

Number of Ayahs: 3

Theme and Subject Matter: Islam has attained complete victory in Arabia, people have started entering His religion in great numbers, the mission for which the Prophet SAW had been sent to the world had been fulfilled

Connection between Surah Nasr and Surah Kafirun

- My outcome is what? → Fath; Allah will help me persevere
- The outcome of a disbeliever is تَب - destruction

Background of surah:

- Only surah in last 10 that is Madani
- Last complete surah to be revealed to Prophet
- Revealed during Fath-e-Makkah
- Indicated the end of the Prophet's life (Abu Bakr crying because he knew end was close)

[1] نصر - some tafseer say this is referring to Hudaybiyyah, not Fath

- All sahabah had to be obedient even if they were against the decisions being made

[2] أفواجا - entering into Islam

فوج makes the scene seem very exciting/rushed to enter Islam; not forced

- Also means army; not helpless in society

فتح indicates a lot of people accepting Islam; not a conquest for your pockets but also for deen

- 3 main groups accepted Islam (120,000 people total)
 1. Tribes of Makkah
 2. Banu Thaqeef; people of Ta'if
 3. Groups from Yemen (some say 30,000 people)
- 6 AH Hudabiyyah (1,500)
- 7 AH Umrah tul Qadaa (10,000)
- 8 AH Fath-e-Makkah
- 10 AH Hajj a tul Widaa3 (120,000)

[3] "First exalt Him with praise."

- The tears of tawbah and regret are not as sweet as the tears of gratitude

فسيح - the letter ف being added shows immediate

Final key points:

- Make duaa for the most mundane things
- It is impossible for our conviction to grow if we only make duaa for huge significant events in life
- We should do istighfar after good deeds because it removed any arrogance
- "Despite how flawed I am, You still let me pray."

Surah Masad

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 111

Order of Revelation: 6

Number of Ayahs: 5

Theme and Subject Matter: Dedicated to Abu Lahab and his Wife

Background of surah:

- Abu Lahab used as an example because he took personal shots against the Prophet
 - First example of this was making fun of Prophet during death of Qasim

- Second example was divorce of his two sons to daughters of Prophet
 - One of the few times the Prophet cursed someone
- Third example is after Prophet's call to Quraysh on Mount Safa
 - تب لك - "May you be destroyed slowly/tortured" Abu Lahab's words
 - Allah's promise will always hold true; Abu Lahab's skin peeled off and people were so afraid, they didn't even pray janazah on him
 - His family had slaves go get his body and tie it in a bag, then throw it into the ground without a prophet barrier

[1] "May the hands of Abu Lahab be ruined and ruined is he"

- The beginning of this surah was the beginning of his end
- Why hands? → hands are the main source of harm on others
- Abd-al-Uzza was his real name (Uzza was the main idol)
 - Nickname was Abu Lahab (father of flame; because he had light skin and rosy cheeks); his wife was Ummi Jameel because she was the most beautiful women
 - Allah calls him by his nickname so that he can't take pride in that name anymore; Father of the flame (of Jahannum now)

[2] "His wealth will not avail him or that which he gained"

- Nothing of this dunya will help you

[3] "He will enter a burning flame"

[4] "And his wife (as well) - carrier of firewood"

إمرا - both muslim and nonmuslim, marriage is not functional or healthy (Asiya)

زوج - only muslims, honor (wife of Lut)

- Allah adds a shaddah to حمالة to indicate she will continuously carry firewood herself
 - She used to make the slavegirls do it and thought herself much higher
 - Allah degraded her to this level

[5] "Around her neck is a rope of twisted fiber (of fire)"

Surah Ikhlas

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 112

Order of Revelation: 22

Number of Ayahs: 4

Theme and Subject Matter: Tawheed, Allah is Eternal, Allah is incomparable

Connection to Previous Surah: Shifting the Prophet's Focus, Allah told the Prophet in Surah Lahab that He would gradually destroy Abu Lahab and his efforts against the message. In Surah Al-Ikhlās, Allah is telling the Prophet to focus on Allah's Oneness alone and conveying it to others, rather than Abu Lahab and his abuse

Background of surah

- Aka Surah Tawheed
- Arabs coming to Prophet and saying lineage is what makes a person honorable
 - "What is Allah's lineage? Why should we worship Him?"
 - Prophet didn't answer and waited for wahiy instead
- Worth 1/3 of Quran; this is why we read it 3 times
- Ikhlas means to free yourself from something; this surah frees Allah from any other relationship, purifying tawheed for us

[1] Say "He is Allah, the One/"

- Emphasizing by adding noun of Allah after pronoun
- Allah is the first and last name in the Quran
- He didn't begin with "Ar-Rahman" because then if a person stops experiencing that quality, they will doubt or reject Allah

[2] "Allah, the Eternal Refuge"

- Allah jumps from His Oneness to a name

الصمد means "The One the entirety of creation relies on and who relies on no one"

- Closest similar relationship is that of mom and baby
- You cannot only read about Allah, you have to speak about His Greatness; increases love

[3] "He never gave birth nor was born."

- Allah does not share attributes with His creation

لم - absolute negation

لا - negation, not absolute

Surah Falaq

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Madinan and others say Makkan

Surah Number: 113

Order of Revelation: 20

Number of Ayahs: 5

Theme and Subject Matter: Seeking refuge with Allah from all evils of the creation, existence of black magic, witchcraft, evil-eye and their remedy

Same reason for revelation and virtues as Surat Al-Nas

Connection between Surah Falaq and Surah Nas

- Falaq is seeking protection from others, Nas is from Shaytan and internal harm

Background of surah

- Some say this surah was revealed after Jewish woman did magic on Prophet
 - Makki surah (revealed as a protection) but this story took place in Madinah and the Prophet reciting it during this story was its main use
- With every ayah of Falaq and Nas (including bismillah), a knot undid

'Ayn is the baby of black magic; simply looking at someone and wondering why you don't have it

- Jealousy is usually for one quality in particular, 'Ayn is more of a wider reach/more difficult to treat
- Reciting Falaq and Nas and blowing it, spreading it on body of kids comes from the fact that Aisha did it for the Prophet when he was sick

Seeking protection from 4 things

1. Evil which He created
2. Evil of darkness when it settled
3. Evil of blower of knows
4. Evil of an envier when he envies

استعاذ - to feel protected (like a child from its mother)

- This is how we should feel with Allah
- We are seeking refuge in Allah, not for protection but to FEEL protected

فلق means to tear open and the morning daybreak

[1] The reason the word Falaq is used is because people who sin or do things like black magic will likely do it in the dark and at night

- "Lord of Daybreak" - Shaytan left and light will make people feel less lonely

[2] From the evil of that which He created

- The One who created evil can save you from it
- Allah didn't cause the chaos and corruption but He created the humans who did the evil

ماخلق means all creations and living things - sky, animals, water v من is only humans/jinns

[3] "And from the evil of darkness when it settles."

غسق - darkness just came

وقب - darkness that is there to stay

- Best time to make dua is after asr salah; do not pray at that time

[4] “And from the evil of the blower of knots”

النفاثات - concept of this magic was done by women at time of Prophet

نفث - To blow with a little bit of spit coming out of the mouth

نفخ - To blow really hard with your mouth (trumpet)

تنفس - To breathe (nafs being blown into)

[5] “And from the evil of the envier when he envies”

شر - evil has the same roots as شرارا - fire

- It doesn't matter the amount, just the environment matters
- A small fire can burn down an entire direct
- A little bit of hasad can destroy an entire family

Surah Nas

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Madinan and some say Makkan

Surah Number: 114

Order of Revelation: 21

Number of Ayahs: 6

Theme and Subject Matter: Existence of evil whisperers among mankind and the jinn, seeking refuge with Allah from evil whispers

[1] رب has 3 meanings

1. Caretaker; not the kind that just leaves you
2. Ownership; Allah owns us
3. Clear access/full rights
 - a. Very comforting to know that Allah will always be present in our lives
 - b. Both the oppressed and the oppressor should know Allah is رب

[2] ملك - owner

- Exclusive to ownership
- Rabb can be misinterpreted because there are 3 meanings; Allah is saying “Let it be clear- I own you”

- Humans are like Shaytan in the sense that we are good at planting thoughts and letting those thoughts fester

[3] إله - someone you turn towards to be worshipped

- Allah is an original name but horizontal line of other similar names
- There are no atheists on a sinking ship

[4] شر - evil - a spark

- You might not be the one who broke the family but you began the spark

وسوسة - whispers

هامس - the one who whispers good or bad

وسواس - whispering only in negative context (hamazah)

إلهام - positive whispering (what made Musa's mother put him in basket) - wahiyy

Ayahs 1-4 are to show Allah's might and that He will take care of us no matter what

[4] خناس - retreating whispers

- Shaytan is in it for the long run; he only retreats to repeat, sometimes in different ways
- He will only attack in ways he knows will tempt us

How do you know you have reached high eman? - If you do good and that makes you feel good

[5] "Who whispers into the chests of mankind"

Qalb- heart, صدور - chest, فؤاد - deepest part of the heart

- Only One with access to hearts and can change them is Allah
- Shaytan only enters our heart if we let him

[6] "From among the jinn and mankind"